

Here in Heaven

Current Store Audit Report

Document Status: Draft

Version: 1.0

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Date: August 4, 2026

Project Phase: Phase 0 — Discovery & Requirements

System Reviewed: Current storefront (hosted on Big Cartel, not Shopify)

Primary URL: the-midnight-market.bigcartel.com (currently mapped/branded as hereinheaven.net)

1. Document Control

Field	Details
Document Title	Here in Heaven — Current Store Audit Report
Version	1.0
Author	Yarely Bustos
Reviewer	Jonathan Canales
Date Created	August 4, 2026
Last Updated	August 4, 2026
Purpose	Evaluate the current storefront and define rebuild requirements for the custom full-stack application.

2. Executive Summary

Summary

This audit reviewed the live "Here in Heaven" storefront (currently built on Big Cartel, not Shopify as originally assumed) across all customer-facing pages: Home, All Products, three category pages, a product detail page, Cart, three-step Checkout, and Contact. The goal was to document existing functionality, identify gaps, and inform requirements for the custom full-stack rebuild.

Key Findings

- The store runs on Big Cartel, not Shopify — this changes prior assumptions and explains several feature limitations.
- The catalog totals 22 products across 3 categories (Shirts: 6, Sweatshirts & Hoodies: 6, Accessories: 10), with no sorting or filtering options anywhere on the site.
- The checkout flow is well-built for a small catalog: a clear 4-step progress bar (Cart → Details → Shipping → Payment), Stripe-powered payments, and PayPal/Afterpay/Klarna financing options throughout.
- The site has only 6 pages total and is missing an About page.

Key Recommendations

- Build native sorting (price, newest, featured) and filtering (category, size, color) into the rebuild — this is the single biggest UX gap today.
- Preserve the checkout UX pattern (step progress bar, editable steps, financing options) as the benchmark for the new build.
- Add an About page and consider product reviews / size charts to build buyer trust as the catalog grows.

Overall Assessment

The current store is functional and covers the core buy flow end-to-end, but its simplicity is largely a platform limitation (Big Cartel) rather than a deliberate design choice. The rebuild should prioritize discovery features (sort/filter), catalog scalability, and an admin experience for the store owner, while keeping the checkout flow's clarity intact.

3. Project Background

Business Context

Here in Heaven is a real apparel and branded merchandise brand (shirts, hoodies/sweatshirts, and accessories like stickers, mousepads, totes, posters, and flags) currently sold through a Big Cartel storefront. The store is being rebuilt as a custom full-stack application to give the owner more control, better UX, and a platform that can scale beyond Big Cartel's constraints.

Project Goal

Replace the current storefront with a custom-built, production-ready full-stack e-commerce web application (React/Vite, Node.js/Express, MySQL/PostgreSQL, Stripe).

Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role	Interest in Project
Store Owner	Jonathan Canales	Needs a stable, easy-to-manage storefront that replaces manual Big Cartel limitations

Customers	End buyers	Want easy browsing, filtering, and a smooth, trustworthy checkout
Developer	Yarely Bustos	Needs a portfolio-grade project demonstrating full-stack engineering skills

4. Audit Objectives

- Understand the current storefront experience.
- Identify all major customer-facing and owner-facing features.
- Document strengths, weaknesses, and missing capabilities.
- Define what must be preserved in the rebuild.
- Support MVP definition and Phase 1 system design.

5. Scope

In Scope

- Public-facing pages
- Product browsing experience
- Product detail pages
- Cart flow
- Checkout flow
- Existing business requirements

Out of Scope

- Big Cartel/back-office admin internals not available to reviewer
- Sales analytics
- Customer database internals
- Mobile responsiveness (not yet tested — flag as open item)
- Third-party app configuration details

Assumptions and Constraints

- Audit performed from the public storefront view only.
- Platform is actually Big Cartel, not Shopify as originally assumed — this should be corrected in all project documentation.
- Some back-office workflows (product management, order viewing, image upload) require owner confirmation since admin access was not reviewed.
- Findings reflect the store state as of August 2026.

6. Methodology

Audit Method

- Manual walkthrough of the live storefront
- Page-by-page review (Home, All Products, 3 category pages, Product Detail, Cart, Checkout x3 steps, Contact)
- Customer journey test from browsing to checkout
- Feature inventory documentation

Evidence Collected

- Screenshots/PDF captures of each page
- Written observations
- Feature and page tables

7. Current State Overview

Summary of Experience

A customer lands on the Home page and immediately sees a shipping-availability banner (U.S., U.K., Canada, E.U., Australia only), followed by a 3-column grid of all 22 featured products with image, name, and price. Navigation includes Home, All Products, Search, three category links (Shirts, Sweatshirts & Hoodies, Accessories), and Contact. Product discovery is entirely manual — there is no sorting or filtering. Clicking into a product shows a detail page with image previews, description, size dropdown, financing options (PayPal, Afterpay, Klarna), and a "You might also like" recommendation grid. Adding to cart updates the nav bar cart count and subtotal live. Checkout is a clean 4-step flow (Cart → Details → Shipping → Payment) with Stripe-processed payments, editable prior steps, and a persistent order summary.

8. Page Inventory

Page Name	URL	Purpose	Key Elements	Included in Rebuild?
Home	/	Landing/discovery entry point	Shipping banner, 22-product grid (3 cols), nav bar, category links, social icons	Yes
All Products	/products	Full catalog browsing	Same 22 products, 3x8 grid, no sort/filter	Yes

Shirts (category)	/category/shirts	Category browsing	6 shirt products	Yes
Sweatshirts & Hoodies (category)	/category/sweatshirts-hoodies	Category browsing	6 products (3 hoodies, 3 sweatshirts)	Yes
Accessories (category)	/category/accessories	Category browsing	10 products (stickers, mousepads, tote, poster, flag)	Yes
Product Detail	/product/[slug]	Single product view + purchase	Image + 2 previews, name/price, financing badges, size dropdown, add to cart, description, "You might also like" grid	Yes
Cart	/cart	Review items before checkout	Item rows (image, name, size, qty, price), subtotal, financing messaging, checkout button, share-cart link	Yes
Checkout (Details/Shipping/Payment)	/checkout	Complete purchase	4-step progress bar, express checkout w/ Klarna, contact + shipping form, shipping method selection, Stripe payment (card/PayPal/Afterpay), order summary	Yes
Contact	/contact	Customer inquiries	Name, email, subject, message fields, send button	Yes
About	—	Not currently present	N/A — recommended addition	Yes (new)

9. Feature Inventory

Feature	User Type	Exists Now?	Priority	Notes
Browse products	Customer	Yes	Must Have	Grid layout, image/name/price only
Sort products	Customer	No	Must Have	Missing entirely — price, newest, featured
Filter by category	Customer	Yes (via nav links only)	Must Have	No in-page filter UI, only separate category pages
Filter by size/color	Customer	No	Should Have	Not available anywhere
Search	Customer	Yes	Must Have	Popup search bar with input + icon
Product detail page	Customer	Yes	Must Have	Includes size dropdown, description, recommendations
Add to cart	Customer	Yes	Must Have	Button shows temporary "Added!" confirmation
Update cart quantity	Customer	Yes	Must Have	+ / - controls and Remove link in cart
Checkout	Customer	Yes	Must Have	4-step flow, Stripe-powered
Guest checkout	Customer	Yes	Must Have	No login required in observed flow
Order confirmation	Customer	Unknown	Must Have	Not captured in audit — needs confirmation
Account / order history	Customer	Unknown	Nice to Have	Not observed — confirm with owner
Product management	Owner	Unknown (admin not reviewed)	Must Have	Requires owner confirmation of current Big Cartel admin capabilities
Order viewing	Owner	Unknown	Must Have	Requires owner confirmation

Image upload	Owner	Unknown	Must Have	Requires owner confirmation
About page content	Customer	No	Should Have	Page does not currently exist

10. Findings

Finding 1 — No sorting or filtering on product listings

Area Reviewed: Product Discovery / Navigation

Severity: High

Criteria: Customers should be able to sort (price, newest, featured) and filter (category, size, color) product listings.

Condition: Home, All Products, and all three category pages display products only in a static 3-column grid with no sort or filter controls.

Cause: Likely a Big Cartel platform limitation combined with a small catalog that has not yet required this feature.

Impact / Risk: As the catalog grows, customers will struggle to find relevant items, increasing bounce rate and reducing conversions.

Recommendation: Build native sort (price asc/desc, newest, featured) and filter (category, size, color) into the product listing API and UI from day one.

Evidence: Home_page.pdf, All_Products_page.pdf, Shirts_page.pdf, Sweatshirts_Hoodies_page.pdf, Accessories_page.pdf, Current Shop Audit.pdf

Finding 2 — Missing About page

Area Reviewed: Site Structure / Branding

Severity: Medium

Criteria: A branded storefront should include an About page communicating brand story and building customer trust.

Condition: The site has only 6 pages (Home, All Products, 3 category pages, Contact); no About page exists.

Cause: Page was likely never prioritized on the current small, simple Big Cartel build.

Impact / Risk: Missing brand storytelling can reduce customer trust and weaken brand identity versus competitors.

Recommendation: Add an About page to the rebuild scope, covering brand story, mission, and founder background.

Evidence: Current Shop Audit.pdf (page inventory), full page walkthrough

Finding 3 — Checkout and cart flow is strong and should be preserved

Area Reviewed: Cart / Checkout

Severity: Low (positive finding)

Criteria: A checkout flow should be clear, low-friction, and offer multiple trusted payment options.

Condition: Checkout uses a clear 4-step progress bar (Cart → Details → Shipping → Payment), all prior steps remain editable, and payment is processed via Stripe with Card, PayPal, and Afterpay support alongside Klarna express checkout.

Cause: N/A — this is a strength rather than a defect.

Impact / Risk: This is a proven UX pattern; deviating from it in the rebuild could introduce friction and hurt conversion.

Recommendation: Replicate this checkout structure (step indicator, editable steps, multi-payment options via Stripe) in the new build.

Evidence: Cart_page.pdf, Checkout_p1.pdf, Checkout_p2.pdf, Checkout_p3.pdf

11. Strengths

- Clear, low-friction 4-step checkout flow with Stripe, PayPal, Afterpay, and Klarna support
- Consistent product card layout (image, name, price) across all listing pages
- Product detail page includes helpful "You might also like" recommendations
- Persistent shipping-region banner sets clear expectations upfront

12. Weaknesses and Gaps

- No sorting or filtering options anywhere in the catalog
- No About page — missing brand storytelling
- No visible size chart or customer reviews on product detail pages
- Order confirmation and owner-facing admin features (product management, order viewing, image upload) were not observable from the public storefront and need owner confirmation
- Platform (Big Cartel) inherently limits customization compared to a custom-built app

13. MVP Implications

Must Include in MVP

- Product browsing with category filter
- Product detail page with size selection
- Cart with quantity updates
- Stripe-powered checkout
- Order confirmation
- Admin product management (add/edit/delete), order viewing, image upload

Should Improve in MVP

- Sorting (price, newest, featured)
- Filtering by size/color
- About page

Post-Launch / Nice to Have

- Customer accounts and order history
- Product reviews/ratings
- Size chart / fit guide
- Return/refund policy

14. Risks and Open Questions

Question	Why It Matters	Owner / Source	Status
What does order confirmation currently look like (email vs. on-screen)?	Determines what must be replicated for MVP	Store owner	Open
What admin capabilities exist today in Big Cartel (product add/edit/delete, order viewing, image upload)?	Defines minimum admin feature parity for rebuild	Store owner	Open
Are customer accounts / order history required at launch or a stretch goal?	Affects MVP scope and auth requirements	Store owner / developer decision	Open
Is stock/inventory tracked by size today?	Affects database schema design	Store owner	Open

Are discount codes required in MVP?	Affects checkout feature scope	Store owner	Open
Does the store owner have full export access to current product data from Big Cartel or will everything need to be manually re-entered?	Affects Database setup	Store owner	Open

15. Recommendations and Next Actions

Recommendation	Priority	Why It Matters	Owner	Target Phase
Design product schema with category, size, and color as filterable fields	High	Enables sort/filter from day one, the biggest current UX gap	Developer	Phase 1
Add About page content and design	Medium	Improves brand trust and storytelling	Store owner + developer	Phase 1
Confirm current admin/back-office capabilities with store owner	High	Needed to scope admin feature parity	Store owner	Phase 0
Replicate proven checkout UX (step bar, editable steps, Stripe/PayPal/Afterpay)	High	Preserves a working, low-friction conversion flow	Developer	Phase 1
Decide on customer accounts / order history scope	Medium	Affects auth architecture decisions	Developer + store owner	Phase 0/1

16. Conclusion

The current storefront (built on Big Cartel, not Shopify) is functional and successfully carries customers from browsing through a well-structured, Stripe-powered checkout. Its main limitations are discovery-related — no sorting or filtering — along with a thin page set that lacks brand storytelling via an About page. These gaps are largely platform constraints rather than deliberate UX choices, and the rebuild should prioritize native sort/filter capability, a scalable product schema, and admin tooling for the store owner, while preserving the proven checkout flow as a UX benchmark.

17. Appendix A — Screenshots

- Home page  Home_page.pdf
- All Products page  All_Products_page.pdf
- Shirts category  Shirts_page.pdf
- Sweatshirts & Hoodies category  Sweatshirts_Hoodies_page.pdf
- Accessories category  Accessories_page.pdf
- Cart page  Cart_page.pdf
- Checkout step 1 — Details  Checkout_p1.pdf
- Checkout step 2 — Shipping  Checkout_p2.pdf
- Checkout step 3 — Payment  Checkout_p3.pdf
- Contact page  Contact_page.pdf

18. Appendix B — User Stories Created from Audit

- As a customer, I want to sort and filter products by category, size, and color so that I can find items quickly as the catalog grows.
- As a customer, I want to select my size before checkout so that I order the right variant.
- As a customer, I want to view a brand About page so that I understand who I am buying from.
- As a store owner, I want to add, edit, and delete products easily so that the catalog stays current.
- As a store owner, I want to view incoming orders so that I can fulfill them promptly.

19. Appendix C — Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	August 4, 2026	[Your name]	Initial draft, populated from page-by-page audit and Current Shop Audit.pdf